had unpleasant side effects—loosens the bowels—which I learned the hard way at a mate's wedding.

Over dinner one night at Highgrove, Pa and I spoke at some length about what I'd been suffering. I gave him the particulars, told him story after story. Towards the end of the meal he looked down at his plate and said softly: *I suppose it's my fault. I should've got you the help you needed years ago.*

I assured him that it wasn't his fault. But I appreciated the apology.

As autumn neared my anxiety was heightened, I think, by my impending birthday, the last of my twenties. Dregs of my youth, I thought. I was beset by all the traditional doubts and fears, asked myself all the basic questions people ask when they get older. Who am I? Where am I going? Normal, I told myself, except that the press was abnormally echoing my self-questioning.

Prince Harry…Why Won't He Marry?

They dredged up every relationship I'd ever had, every girl I'd ever been seen with, put it all into a blender, hired "experts," a.k.a. quacks, to try to make sense of it. Books about me dived into my love life, homed in on each romantic failure and near miss. I seem to recall one detailing my flirtation with Cameron Diaz. Harry just couldn't see himself with her, the author reported. Indeed I couldn't, since we'd never met. I was never within fifty meters of Ms. Diaz, further proof that if you like reading pure bollocks then royal biographies are just your thing.

Behind all this hand-wringing about me was something more substantive than "tittle-tattle." It went to the whole underpinning of the monarchy, which was *based* on marriage. The great controversies about kings and queens, going back centuries, generally centered on whom they married, and whom they didn't, and the children who issued from those unions. You weren't a fully vested member of the Royal Family, indeed a true human being, until you were wed. No coincidence that Granny, head of state in sixteen countries, started every speech: "My husband and I…" When Willy and Kate married they became The Duke and Duchess of Cambridge, but more important they became a Household, and as such were entitled to